Week # 12: 16/11/2026 – 20/11/2026

Subject: English Language Arts **Unit Title: Testing Our Limits** **Grade: 6**

Lessons	Learning targets	Assessment tools and strategies Formative/ Summative/ Differentiation	Resources and links for Parents
Lesson 1: First Read Cocoon	**I can:** • read "Cocoon" independently and summarise what happens in the poem in one or two sentences. • identify the speaker, the subject and the structure of the poem (stanzas, line breaks and rhyme). • predict how the title "Cocoon" connects to the idea of testing our limits.	• **Formative:** first-read annotation (circle unfamiliar words, write one question in the margin). • **Formative:** exit ticket: a one-sentence summary and one "I wonder ..." question. • **Differentiation:** teacher reads the poem aloud first; illustrated word bank (cocoon, caterpillar, chrysalis, transform) for students with additional needs. • **Extension:** explain what a "cocoon" could represent in a person's life.	Cocoon Poem
Lesson 2 Close Read Cocoon	**I can:** • identify examples of imagery and figurative language in "Cocoon" and explain their effect. • explain the connotations of key words and how they create the tone and mood of the poem. • cite evidence from the poem to support my interpretation.	• **Formative:** colour-coded close-reading annotation (imagery, figurative language, tone words). • **Formative:** think-pair-share on guided text-dependent questions; teacher circulates and checks annotations. • **Differentiation:** sentence frames ("The word ___ suggests ___ because ___"); mixed-ability pairs. • **Extension:** analyse how a line break or stanza break shapes meaning.	Glossary of Poetic Terms (Poetry Foundation)

Lesson 3 Interpreting Poetry	**I can:** • determine the theme of "Cocoon" and explain how specific details convey it. • explain how the structure of the poem (stanzas and line breaks) develops the theme. • write a RACE paragraph that interprets the poem and connects it to "testing our limits".	• **Formative:** RACE paragraph (Criterion A practice) with peer feedback against the success criteria. • **Formative:** theme statement written as a complete sentence, not a single word. • **Differentiation:** RACE paragraph frame and theme statement bank for students with additional needs. • **Extension:** compare how "Cocoon" and "When an Old Man Gets to Thinking" present change across a lifetime.	Cocoon Poem
Lesson 4 Achieve 3000	**I can:** • read a levelled informational article and determine its central idea. • answer comprehension questions using evidence from the article. • write a well-structured response to the Thought Question.	• **Formative:** Achieve 3000 activity score (target 75% or higher on the first attempt). • **Formative:** Thought Question response checked for a clear answer and textual evidence. • **Differentiation:** articles are automatically levelled to each student's Lexile; teacher conferences with a small focus group.	Achieve 3000
Homework	• Complete one Achieve 3000 article and activity (aim for 75% or higher). • Re-read "Cocoon" and write 3 to 4 sentences: When have you had to test your limits in order to grow?	• **Formative:** Achieve 3000 scores reviewed; reflections shared at the start of the next lesson.	Achieve 3000
Teacher's notes/ Reminders	• Use the V2 scaffolds (word help, visuals, sentence frames) for students with additional needs. • Collect the Lesson 3 RACE paragraphs and give written feedback against Criterion A before the next poetry task. • Check the Achieve 3000 usage and score report on Friday and follow up with students below 75%. • Display the inquiry question throughout the week and revisit it in each plenary.		

Technology Integration	• Adobe Acrobat online: access to the poem and digital annotation. • Achieve 3000: levelled reading, auto-marked activities and Lexile progress data.

Cross-curricular links	• **Science:** life cycles and metamorphosis (caterpillar, chrysalis, butterfly). • **Wellbeing:** growth mindset and resilience when facing challenges.
External Assessment Integration	• Achieve 3000 Lexile data used to track reading growth. • Reading skills practised (central idea, citing evidence, figurative language) align with the reading strands of external benchmark assessments such as MAP Growth Reading.
Wellbeing/ ATL Skills	• **Thinking:** interpreting figurative language and drawing conclusions about theme. • **Communication:** reading critically and writing structured RACE paragraphs. • **Self-management:** reflecting on resilience and personal growth through the cocoon metaphor. • **Social:** giving and receiving peer feedback respectfully.
Standards	• CAS 2.1.a.i (RL.6.1) Cite textual evidence to support analysis and inferences. • CAS 2.1.a.ii (RL.6.2) Determine a theme or central idea and explain how it is conveyed through details. • CAS 2.1.b.i (RL.6.4) Determine the meaning of words and phrases, including figurative and connotative meanings, and analyze their impact on meaning and tone. • CAS 2.1.b.ii (RL.6.5) Analyze how a sentence, chapter, scene, or stanza contributes to the development of theme, setting, or plot. • CAS 2.3.b.i (L.6.5a) Interpret figures of speech in context. • RI.6.2 Determine a central idea of a text and how it is conveyed through particular details (Achieve 3000).
Inquiry/ TOK Question	What does it mean to “Test your limits?”
Success Criteria (Measurable)	• I can annotate "Cocoon" with at least three labelled examples of imagery or figurative language. • I can write a theme statement as a complete sentence supported by two pieces of evidence from the poem. • I can write a RACE paragraph of 5 to 7 sentences that includes at least one embedded quotation and explains its effect. • I can score 75% or higher on my Achieve 3000 activity.
National Identity Domain	• **Values:** perseverance and resilience. Students link the transformation in "Cocoon" to Emirati role models who overcame challenges, such as Sarah Al Amiri and the Hope Probe team studied earlier in the unit.